

Advanced Web Programming

SIB245007 | D-IV Sistem Informasi Bisnis

Meeting 2: **HTTP Protocol and the MVC Pattern**

Request/Response Cycle & Web Application Architecture

What You'll Learn

1. Explaining the HTTP **request/response** cycle (method, status code, header) and mapping it onto routing code
2. Comparing the **MVC**, **MVVM**, and **Clean Architecture** patterns, and explaining how Laravel implements MVC
3. Recognizing the roles of **route**, **controller**, and **middleware**, including modern routing patterns: **route parameters**, **named routes**, **route groups**, and **resource routing**
4. Explaining how to organize controllers: **resource controllers**, **single-action controllers**, and the *thin controller* principle

This slide covers concepts. The practical steps for writing routes, controllers, and middleware are covered separately outside this slide.

Part 1

The Post Office Analogy

A letter

- Comes in through the intake counter
- The clerk reads the address & type of mail
- Forwarded to the right department
- The clerk doesn't open the envelope or decide the reply's content

A request to a web application

- Comes in through one door
- Sorted by its address & type
- Forwarded to the right handler for processing
- The sorter doesn't decide the response's content

If the sorting goes wrong (e.g. a delete-data request gets forwarded without checking whether the sender is an admin), the application loses control over who's allowed to change what.

Anatomy of a Request

Request: what a browser sends to a server, carrying a method, an address (URL), headers, and sometimes data (a form, JSON).

Route: a rule mapping one combination of method and URL to the code that will handle it.

- Every request always carries a **method** stating the request's intent
- It's this method that determines which route matches, not the URL alone

HTTP Methods

Method	Meaning	Typical Use
GET	Requesting data, without changing anything server-side	Listing data
POST	Submitting new data	Saving new data
PATCH	Updating part of existing data	Updating part of a record
DELETE	Removing data	Deleting a record

Other methods worth knowing: **PUT** (replacing all of the data at once), **HEAD** (like **GET** but only asking for headers, no body), **OPTIONS** (asking which methods the server allows).

Full list of methods: developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Web/HTTP/Reference/Methods

Method Ground Rules: Safe & Idempotent

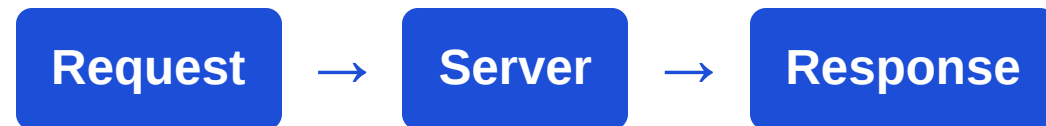
Safe: methods that don't change anything server-side: GET , HEAD . **Idempotent:** methods that produce the same result no matter how many times they're sent: GET , PUT , DELETE ; POST is not.

- Browsers & servers assume this rule is followed: refresh, the back button, and caching all depend on it
- POST isn't idempotent, which is why the save-then-redirect pattern on the next slide is needed

Strict rule: GET must never change data server-side. Breaking this rule makes application behavior unpredictable, e.g. refreshing a page accidentally deleting data.

Anatomy of a Response

Response: what a server sends back to a browser, carrying a status code, headers, and a body (HTML, JSON, a redirect).



A response always carries a **status code**, a three-digit number summarizing the outcome before a single byte of the body gets read.

The Five Status Code Classes

Hundreds of status codes are grouped by their first digit: you only need to memorize the five classes, not every code.

Class	Meaning	The Gist
1xx	Informational	"Received, still processing", rarely seen directly
2xx	Success	The request was processed successfully
3xx	Redirection	The browser is told to go to another address
4xx	Client Error	A mistake on the sender's side (wrong address, invalid data)
5xx	Server Error	A mistake on the server's side

Full list: developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Web/HTTP/Reference/Status

Status Codes on a Web Application

Code	Meaning	Typical Use
200	OK	A list page renders successfully
302	Redirect	After a form saves, the browser is sent to the detail page
404	Not Found	Opening a detail page for an ID that doesn't exist
422	Unprocessable Entity	A form is submitted with invalid data
500	Server Error	An unhandled error on the server side

- Notice the pattern: 2xx = success, 3xx = address change, 4xx = sender-side mistake, 5xx = server-side mistake

The 302 Pattern: Save-then-Redirect

POST /articles



302 + Location



GET /articles/{id}

After `POST /articles` successfully saves data, the server doesn't send HTML back right away: it sends a 302 response with a `Location` header telling the browser to request another address instead.

- This pattern repeats across almost every data-writing feature
- Stops a user from hitting **refresh** and accidentally submitting the same data twice

Headers: Metadata Outside the Body

Header: metadata that accompanies a request or response, outside its main body.

Request headers (browser → server)

- **Content-Type** : format of the data being sent
- **Accept** : the response format wanted
- **Authorization** : sender's identity token
- **Cookie** : session data sent back

Response headers (server → browser)

- **Content-Type** : format of the response body
- **Location** : the redirect target address
- **Set-Cookie** : the server hands off session data
- **Cache-Control** : whether the response may be cached

Full list of headers: developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Web/HTTP/Reference/Headers

Seeing HTTP Directly

- Modern browsers provide **DevTools** → **the Network tab** to see every request-response that happens
- Each row shows: method, address, status code, and response time
- The most direct way to prove that "behind every click is a real HTTP request"

You'll put this straight into practice: opening DevTools and watching real requests from routes you build yourself.

Part 2

The Problem MVC Solves

- Just accepting requests and sending responses isn't enough to keep code clean as an application grows
- Without a firm separation of responsibilities, code that "sorts requests", "fetches data", and "builds the display" ends up mixed in one file
- The **MVC** (Model-View-Controller) pattern answers this by drawing a firm line between three responsibilities

Model, View, and Controller

MVC: the Model owns data, the View owns presentation, the Controller owns the request flow between them.

Back to the post-office analogy

- Controller = the sorting clerk
- Model = the filed records holding the actual data
- View = the reply form handed to the sender

Practical rule for where code goes

- Touches data → Model
- Handles request flow → Controller
- Renders output → View

The framework doesn't enforce this: a query inside a view still runs. This pattern is a discipline the code's author has to maintain.

MVC in Laravel's Folder Structure

Folder	MVC Role
routes/web.php	Controller: URL registration
app/Http/Controllers/	Controller: request-handling classes
app/Models/	Model: data representation & business rules
resources/views/	View: what the user sees

This folder structure isn't an accident: it embodies the same MVC pattern as the diagram earlier.

MVVM

MVVM (Model-View-ViewModel): inserts a ViewModel between Model and View; the ViewModel holds view state and keeps it automatically synced to the View through two-way binding.

- Popular in **reactive** interface applications: the display keeps changing without a page reload
- More relevant to frontend frameworks (e.g. Vue) than to server-rendered applications in general

Clean Architecture

Clean Architecture: isolates core business rules (use cases) entirely from whatever framework is in use, so they can be tested, and even moved to a different framework, without being touched.

- Benefit: business rules can be tested and moved without depending on the framework
- Cost: an extra abstraction layer that needs maintaining

For a small-to-medium scale application, isolation this strict adds abstraction that isn't yet worth its cost. Laravel's built-in MVC is already clean enough.

Comparing the Three Patterns

Pattern	Main Separation	Typical Use
MVC	Model, View, Controller	Laravel (built-in)
MVVM	Model, View, ViewModel	Applications with two-way binding between view and state
Clean Architecture	Use-case layer isolated from the framework	Large systems with heavy business logic

Part 3

From URLs to clean controllers

Route, Controller, and Middleware

Controller: a class holding request-handling methods, invoked by whichever route matches.

Middleware: a layer that inspects or transforms a request before it reaches a controller, for example checking whether the user is logged in.

Request



Route



Middleware



Controller

- The hands-on practicum will apply all three to the Simple POS case study

Route Parameters: Dynamic Addresses

Route parameter: a part of the address written in curly braces, e.g. `{id}` , whose value gets filled in from the real URL and passed to the controller.

```
Route::get('/articles/{id}', [ArticleController::class, 'show']);
```

- `/articles/1` , `/articles/2` , `/articles/9999` : one route serves them all
- The `{id}` value is received by the `show` method as an argument
- A missing ID → **404** (see the status code table back in Part 1)

Named Routes: Addresses Can Change, Names Don't

Named route: a unique label attached to a route via `->name()` , so the rest of the application refers to that name instead of the raw address.

```
Route::get('/login', [LoginController::class, 'create'])
    ->name('login.create');
Route::post('/login', [LoginController::class, 'store'])
    ->name('login.store');
```

- `GET /login` and `POST /login` are **two different routes** even though the address is the same, distinguished by their method
- Links/redirects are written as `route('login.create')` . Address changes from `/login` to `/signin` ? No caller needs editing
- Naming convention: `source.action` , e.g. `articles.index` , `articles.store` , etc.

Route Groups: Shared Rules

Route group: wraps several routes so they share the same middleware, address prefix, or name prefix, written once, applied to all of them.

```
Route::middleware('auth')->group(function () {  
    Route::get('/dashboard', [DashboardController::class, 'index'])  
        ->name('dashboard');  
    Route::get('/settings', [SettingController::class, 'edit'])  
        ->name('settings.edit');  
});
```

A new route that forgets to be wrapped in the right middleware group is an easy-to-miss security hole: a delete-data route meant only for admins becomes accessible to anyone who knows the address. Always check a new route's position before considering it done.

Resource Controllers: Seven Conventional Actions

Any CRUD feature always needs the same seven actions. Laravel standardizes them into a naming convention for controller methods.

Action	Method	URL	Task
index	GET	/articles	List all articles
create	GET	/articles/create	Add-article form
store	POST	/articles	Save a new article
show	GET	/articles/{id}	A single article's detail
edit	GET	/articles/{id}/edit	Edit-article form
update	PATCH	/articles/{id}	Save changes
destroy	DELETE	/articles/{id}	Delete an article

Route::resource: Seven Routes, One Line

```
Route::resource('articles', ArticleController::class);
```

- This one line registers all 7 routes from the previous slide at once, complete with named routes (`articles.index` , `articles.show` , etc.)
- Only need some of them? `->only(['index', 'show'])`
- The same convention across every feature means anyone on the team instantly knows where an action lives

The `php artisan route:list` command shows a table of every registered route (method, URL, name, and middleware) without opening route files one by one.

Single-Action Controller

Single-action controller: a controller with one `__invoke()` method for one single task, used when an action doesn't make sense folded into the seven resource actions.

```
Route::get('/articles/{id}/pdf', ExportArticlePdfController::class);
```

- Exporting an article as a PDF isn't `show`, isn't `update`: it's a standalone action
- Its route points straight at the class, with no method name
- A sign you need one: an action keeps getting "forced" into a resource method that doesn't fit

The Thin Controller Principle

Thin controller: a controller only handles flow: accepting a request, calling the right party, choosing a response. Business rules live in the Model (or a service layer), not the controller.

Fat controller (avoid)

- Calculate totals, validate input, send notifications, format output: all in one method
- Hard to test, hard to reuse

Thin controller (the goal)

- `store` only validates input, hands the calculation off to the Model, then redirects
- The business logic can be reused from anywhere

Remember the rule from Part 2: touches data → Model, handles flow → Controller. A fat controller is a slow-motion violation of MVC: each line feels small, until one day your `store` method is 200 lines long.

Summary

- A request carries a **method** (GET / POST / PATCH / DELETE + PUT / HEAD / OPTIONS); a response carries a **status code** split into five classes (1xx – 5xx); **headers** carry metadata in both directions
- **MVC** separates Model (data), View (presentation), Controller (flow); **MVVM** suits reactive interfaces; **Clean Architecture** suits large systems. Laravel maps MVC directly onto its folder structure
- Modern routing: **route parameters** ({id}), **named routes** (->name()), **route groups** (shared middleware/prefix), and **Route::resource** which registers seven actions at once
- Controller organization: **resource controllers** for CRUD, **single-action controllers** for standalone actions, and the **thin controller** principle: flow in the controller, business rules in the Model

References & Discussion

Official Laravel documentation · MDN Web Docs (developer.mozilla.org) · Fielding's (2000) dissertation on REST

Full code: `github.com/se-polinema/simple-pos`

Next meeting: Frontend & Templating (Blade, Tailwind, Alpine)